

DigiPick of the month

WIN!

An APUS Pen Drive worth Rs 2500 just by sharing an amusing picture which a tech angle to it.

Send your picture to digipick@thinkdigit.com. prize-winning picture will be published every month.

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The Age of Software, Not Soft Toys



"Child's Play" sent in by Frederick Noronha, Goa. Congratulations!

the transfers were denied, as expected, but for some reason the eBay request went through.

Interestingly, the boy says he did it for fun, and that he didn't believe it would be possible. He used existing tools on the Internet, without any sophisticated hacking techniques. This leaves open the question of how many other, high-profile sites are in danger of being hijacked.

Also, if it's so easy, why hasn't something like this been done more often - especially when it turns out that the tools to do it are right there on the Net? There's a lot of money to be made off attacks like this one. Once the site is hijacked, the hijacker has potential access to users' usernames, passwords, credit card numbers and other such juicy stuff.

ONLINE DATING

Divorce And The Internet

Statistics from the UK's Office of National Statistics recently reported that divorce rates in England and Wales have risen for the third



successive year, from 2001 to 2003. Can there be a link between divorce and online dating sites? There can, according to Relate, a UK-based counselling service. Christine Northam, a counsellor at Relate, said that sites such as Friends Reunited bring together former lovers, which in turn hastens the breaking up of existing relationships. However, Northam also said that there were other factors at play here as well - including work pressure and a decrease in the stigma associated with divorce.

The number of Web sites that act as a bulletin board for people seeking old school friends and colleagues have risen in the past five years.

A spokeswoman at Friends Reunited said that it was incorrect to suggest that such sites are

undermining marriages and families. Explaining the innocence of sites such as Friends Reunited, she said, "We are no more to blame for divorce rates than the advent of the telephone. We are an intermediary and we ... reunite ...what occurs afterwards is beyond our control."

FriendsReunited.co.uk does seem to make it really easy, though, to find old flames - there are over 11 million members, and it's free to search for old friends.

DVD OVER INTERNET

Ring One Up For Panasonic

It may seem like luxury to the point of uselessness, but still, it's a first. September 8, Panasonic announced a DVD recorder that you can programme over the Internet and via cell phone as well. The DMR-E500H has a 400 GB hard drive, which makes for 700 hours of recorded video. It will be available in Japan beginning September 21. This, and similar players let you watch a program from

People Who Changed Computing

The Pixel

This year, the pixel turns 50. Yet, how many of us are aware?

1954, the year the transistor radio was invented, also saw the birth of the pixel in New Jersey, USA. At Princeton's Institute for Advanced Studies, an enterprising team of mathematicians and engineers created the first ever computer graphic. Their breakthrough effort saw the first instance of digital typography on a computer the size of a Manhattan apartment! The Princeton's pioneers used a small matrix of glowing vacuum tubes to spell out letters. It was the first ever instance of mapping com-



puter memory directly to dots in a display.

Soon, the earliest personal computers, with 300 x 200 screens, sprung up. They came with a separate 'text mode', which still features in Intel-based computers. 30 years after the geniuses at Princeton's created the first pixel, Macintosh entered the scene. And we saw the first PC that treated on-screen text as just another graphic.

Fast forward to 2004-pixels are everywhere. Today, most of our sources of entertainment and work are broken down into pixels, and disseminated digitally through satellite, cable, compact discs, and the Internet. The brainchild of a bunch of New Jersey mathematicians and engineers has revolutionised the way we see the world.